

TATA OFFICIALS VISIT HOLY SHRINES BEFORE THE BIG LAUNCH

THE NANO AT AJMER
SHARIF



DEEPAK SHARMA

CHANDIGARH | Nano Pilgrimage

Ratan Tata's little car has hit the road on a big pilgrimage. Putting its initial manufacturing troubles in West Bengal behind, two freshly-fabricated Nanos drove to the Golden Temple at Amritsar and Ajmer Sharif in Rajasthan to invoke divine blessings for the upcoming commercial launch of the world's cheapest car. Tata Motors officials accompanying the cars offered special prayers at both shrines for the success of their new product. Nano's spiritual odyssey, understood to be Tata's idea, proved to be a test drive of its roadworthiness as well as an ingenious marketing exercise as the small wonder drew curious crowds en route to the places of pilgrimage.

by Ramesh Vinayak

A FAMOUS MUMBAI PROMENADE WILL GET AN ECO-FRIENDLY POWER SURGE

MANDAR DEODHAR



MUMBAI | A Place in the Sun

While Maharashtra reels under a power crisis, Mumbai citizens are doing their bit to save electricity. The 200-m long walkway along the newly-renovated promenade at Bandra's Carter Road will soon be lit using solar energy. Besides the street lamps, the interiors of the walkway and a multi-purpose gazebo have also been fitted with solar panels. Also in the offing is a plan to install a windmill to harvest wind energy in the area during the monsoon. "We

THE WALKWAY



are doing our bit to prevent global warming," says Anandini Thakoor, chairperson, Khar-Bandra-Santacruz Foundation. Built at a cost of Rs 48 lakh from MLA Baba Siddiqui's funds, the sea-facing walkway in the very tony western suburb has an elevated flowerbed and a gazebo. by Aditi Pai

DELHI | Principled Investment

In times of recession, there are investment plans with a religious spin. The HSBC Amanah India Shariah Portfolio from HSBC Asset Management and Taurus Ethical Fund from Taurus Mutual Fund gives investors the opportunity to benefit from returns in conformity with Islamic Shariah principles. According to Waqar Naqvi, CEO, Taurus Mutual Fund, Shariah-compliant businesses have weathered the sub prime crisis due to their ability to filter and avoid speculative businesses. An independent board will monitor stock picks and certify Shariah compliance on a quarterly basis.

by Nivedita Mukherjee



golden pumpkin

TALK ABOUT feet and mouths. CPI spokesman D. Raja recently gave a live demonstration of the wisdom of pausing before saying the first thing that comes to mind. At a recent Delhi function where Martin Luther King III, son of the slain civil rights hero Martin Luther King Jr, was introduced to some national politicians in Delhi, he was greeted with this query from Raja, "When can we expect a King Sub Jr?" The human rights activist was blessed with a daughter last year at the age of 52 and the loquacious Raja obviously thought he'd get a quick quip in. Many in the gathering were left looking for a hole in the floor to disappear into. King III, however, swiftly gathered his wits and replied. "Well, I am trying my best." The er... red faces slowly vanished but the thought still lingered: How more indiscreet could people possibly get?

PANKAJ NANGIA

Raja

